

Video Transcript

Video 7: Uploading and Downloading Files to and from Containers (04:35)

As we have seen, working in a container is a great strategy. It allows us to create a clean development environment on demand, gives us great speed, and we can bypass all of the painful configurations that need to be done by hand. However, at times you might want to interact with that container from your host. That is, you might want to copy some files into it or some files out of it. And so I've provided you here with the following that you can use to be able to do that. And let's go ahead and demonstrate it just to make sure that we are seeing it for what it is.

As you can see here, I have 3 windows. On the left-hand side I have a container, a Java development environment container, and on the right-hand side I have two windows, both of them on my local host. This is a sample directory in my desktop and below it I am in the same location but just at the terminal. I'm going to start off here by creating a file and I'm going to call that file `hello.txt`, and inside of it I'm simply going to say 'Hello World'. Then I'm going to go ahead and save that file, taking a look at the contents to make sure it is what we think it is.

Now as you can see there on the window above is just simply the finder, the graphical view of our file system. And you can see there that I have that file `hello.txt`. Now let's start out by copying that file to the container. And before I do so, let me go ahead and show you the files that I have here. I have three files, `Consumer.class`, `Consumer.java` and a directory called `University`. That's all there is in that directory. Now I want to modify this command, that instruction that I have here to be able to push that new file that we just created called 'hello' into that directory.

So, I'm going to go ahead and use the name of my container. And as you can see here, I have just opened up the dashboard and you can see here that the name of our Java development environment container is called 'javahi'. So, I'm going to go ahead and use that here. So, I'm going to go ahead and modify my container to 'javahi' and then the name of the file that I'm going to be pushing in is called 'hello' and the path that I want to push it into is the home path. So, if we take a look at our path there, it is `/home`.

So, I'm going to go ahead and enter that now and let's go ahead and list our files here. And you

can see here that we now have that file. And if I take a look at the contents, we have 'Hello world!' So, going back to the slides, as you can see there, I have copy one file to container. I have copying from container. So, let's do the opposite, copying from container. And in this case, I have already modified that command to match what we have here.

So, I'm going to go ahead and copy that file. So, I'm going to copy the file that I have here, which is the Consumer.java file. So, I'm going to go ahead and show you the contents of that. And now I'm going to go ahead and copy it locally. And as you can see there on top, that file just appeared. If I look at the contents of it, we would see the same thing that we did within the container. So, as you can see, it's pretty easy to be able to move back and forth into the container, out of the container. I did it for a single file, but you can see there below how to do it for the rest of the directory, all of its contents.

And so if you want to save your work as you go through this and not have it be deleted when you erase your container, this is the way to do it. And you might also want to do it, by the way, whenever you create something outside or you download it from GitHub and you just want to be able to push it in without having to discover how you do it within the container. So, now it's your turn. Go ahead and give it a try. This is a useful thing to know.